

County Administration Workshop: August 25, 2026

1:30 p.m. - Board of Commissioners Conference Room

Attending: Commissioners Ron A. Smith; Colene M. Martin; Gary L. Richardson; and Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 1:30 p.m.

1. Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest

Commissioners Richardson, Martin, and Smith each declared no potential conflicts of interest.

2. Department Business

a. Legal

1. Resolution No. 2026-032 - Water/Sewer Infrastructure Extension Funding

Leah Harper presented Resolution No. 2026-032 supporting Josephine County and the City of Cave Junction in pursuing state funding for planning and engineering associated with extending water and sewer infrastructure toward Kirby and the Illinois Valley Airport. The Board discussed that the County and City would pursue separate state programs serving the same general infrastructure-planning purpose, with Josephine County eligible to lead one application and the City eligible to lead the program limited to communities under 25,000 population. The Board expressed support and directed that the resolution move forward to a Weekly Business Session for public consideration.

2. Letter of Support - City of Cave Junction Water/Sewer Infrastructure Application

Ms. Harper reviewed the companion letter supporting the City of Cave Junction application. The Board confirmed that the request is for planning and feasibility work rather than construction of infrastructure and directed that the letter be placed on the next Weekly Business Session agenda with the related resolution.

b. Finance

1. Amendment to Board Order No. 2026-023 - Economic Development Grant Advisory Committee

Matthew Eide, Finance Director, reviewed proposed revisions to the Economic Development Grant Advisory Committee. Finance recommended reducing the committee from seven members to five because applications had not been received for all of the originally designated categories. The proposal contemplated two business-owner positions and three at-large positions, with one-year terms for the initial committee.

The Board discussed removing employee-count restrictions from the business-owner positions so that applicants from businesses of any size could qualify. Commissioners also discussed geographic representation, industry diversity, conflicts for persons who may wish to apply for County economic-development grants, and the advisory nature of the committee. Finance reported receiving eleven committee applications, including one from Cave Junction and ten from the Grants Pass area. The Board directed Finance to revise the order so both designated positions are simply business-owner positions and to bring the revised order to the following Weekly Business Session, rather than the August 26 meeting.

2. Board Order No. 2026-045 - Economic Development Grant Advisory Committee Bylaws

Finance reviewed draft bylaws, including revisions concerning terms of service and how a tie recommendation would be handled. Commissioner Richardson proposed additional language broadening the definition of economic development beyond direct job creation to include infrastructure or other projects that may generate economic activity, and discussed allowing County departments to compete for grants under the same criteria as other applicants. Other Commissioners requested time to review the proposed revisions and emphasized that the rules should remain general rather than be tailored to specific projects.

The Board tabled the bylaws and the updated economic-development grant application for additional review and directed that both return for discussion at the next Administrative Workshop.

c. Human Resources

1. Collective Bargaining Agreement - Federation of Law Enforcement Officers

Natalie Eckhardt-Doupe, Interim Human Resources Director, and Community Justice staff presented the completed three-year collective bargaining agreement with the Federation of Law Enforcement Officers (FOPO). Human Resources described the negotiations as successful and stated that the agreement brings the bargaining unit closer to market comparables while remaining within a reasonable range for the County.

Commissioner Martin made a motion to approve the Collective Bargaining Agreement – Federation of Law Enforcement Officers. Commissioner Smith seconded. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

2. Position Requisitions and Classification Updates

a. Clerk - Chief Deputy Clerk

Human Resources reported that a Clerk's Office employee had retired and the department requested authority to refill the position. Review of the classification showed that the position had been titled Chief Administrative Supervisor even though the statutory title is Chief Deputy Clerk. Human Resources updated the title and job duties and stated that the position is budgeted and will be posted externally. No objection was stated to proceeding with the recruitment.

b. Sheriff's Office Supervisory Compensation b-f

Human Resources reviewed compensation for five non-union Sheriff's Office supervisory positions - two lieutenants, the undersheriff, the Animal Control Supervisor, and the Lead Dispatcher - after the recently completed Sheriff's Association and Sergeants bargaining agreements created wage compression or overlap with employees they supervise. Several of the affected classifications had not been comprehensively reviewed since 2017-2019. Human Resources completed comparative compensation work and proposed revised scales designed to maintain an approximately \$10,000 separation between the sergeant and lieutenant ranges while remaining generally below nearby comparator agencies.

Finance estimated that the lieutenants and Lead Dispatcher could be accommodated within existing departmental appropriations, while the Animal Control Supervisor and undersheriff adjustments could require approximately \$40,000 from the General Fund. The Board discussed the need to account for secondary compensation effects when collective bargaining agreements are negotiated, the importance of employee retention, maintaining reasonable step differentials, and starting future bargaining early enough to inform the annual budget process. Human Resources stated that the change remained below the threshold requiring a separate supplemental-budget action and that a tracking system would be established so classifications do not go extended periods without review. The Board authorized Human Resources to proceed with the pay-scale adjustments and signatures; no separate formal motion was taken.

3. Emergency Management Director - Removal of Interim Designation

Human Resources presented a personnel action to remove the word "Interim" from the Emergency Management Director title. The position had originally been filled on an interim basis while the County determined the structure of Information Technology and Emergency Management. Following separation of the departments and completion of an external recruitment process, Human Resources requested the title change only. The Board approved the change without objection.

3. Other

No additional matters were introduced.

4. Additional Subject Matters from Commissioners/Announcements

Commissioner Martin noted that the following day's Weekly Business Session would include a robust agenda and expressed appreciation that more matters were being moved to the public session for comment. Chair Smith reminded the public that fire season remains in effect and urged continued caution with fire through the late summer and fall.

The meeting adjourned at 2:15 p.m.